

Assessment Pack: The National Information Ecosystem

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Module purpose

Participants learn to see official statistics as a national information ecosystem rather than as the output of one national statistical office. They identify the institutions, data assets, technologies, flows, users, rules, capabilities and risks that determine whether information is fit for public decisions. They then use that map to locate realistic AI opportunities and the dependencies that must be addressed first.

Performance outcome

Given a country scenario or an approved national domain, the participant can produce a scoped ecosystem map with stable identifiers, evidence references, critical flows, user needs, quality and governance risks, coordination gaps and a justified statement of where AI may or may not add value.

Module	A1
Competencies	C1 Statistical purpose and public value; C3 stewardship; C4 quality; C6 governance; C8 communication.
Entry level	No prior AI expertise required; basic familiarity with a statistical organization or sector.
Exit level	L1 guided practitioner, with an optional L2 workplace assignment.
Structured time	6 hours, delivered as one day or two 3-hour sessions.
Practice share	Approximately 65 percent.
Primary evidence	Completed ecosystem map, flow analysis, risk statement and oral defence.
Phase 1 link	Uses the concepts and record types of Phase 1D.

Package contents

Part	Use
Use	Assessment edition. Apply the rubric consistently and retain an auditable record of feedback and decisions.

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Learning outcomes and evidence

By the end participants can	Evidence
Define the boundary of a national or sector information ecosystem.	Scope statement naming domain, geography, period, users and exclusions.
Distinguish producer, source owner, steward, processor, coordinator, funder, regulator and user roles.	Actor register with role and authority evidence.
Inventory data assets from surveys, censuses, administrative records, research, geospatial and private sources.	Asset register with provenance and quality notes.
Trace one critical information flow from collection or generation to use.	Flow record showing transformations, handoffs, delays and failure points.
Connect user needs to fitness-for-use requirements.	Need-to-asset matrix with unmet or partially met needs.
Identify coordination, capability, quality, legal, security and sustainability risks.	Prioritized gap and risk list.
Locate bounded AI opportunities without assuming AI is the answer.	Opportunity and dependency statement with a proceed, investigate or do not pursue recommendation.

Critical safeguards

- Do not include confidential records, passwords, security details or personal data in the classroom map.
- Label claims as evidenced, reported or unknown. Do not convert informed opinion into fact.
- Map actual decision authority; do not assume the NSO controls every sector source.
- An AI opportunity is not selected until purpose, data access, quality, human responsibility and security are considered.

Exercise 4 User need risk and AI opportunity

Time: 40 minutes. Screen the proposal: “Use generative AI and satellite imagery to produce district crop estimates automatically.” Do not redesign the entire national system. Produce a bounded recommendation.

Screen	Question
Purpose	What exact decision and statistical product are being improved?
Baseline	What current method, timing, cost and error evidence will the proposal be compared with?
Data	Which sources are permitted, representative, sufficiently

Screen	Question
	documented and stable?
Quality	What benchmark, districts, crops, subgroups, seasons and tolerances are required?
Authority	Who owns the estimate, method, review and release decision?
Human oversight	Which qualified person can challenge or override the result?
Security and confidentiality	What information may enter each tool and environment?
Sustainability	What skills, funding, infrastructure, supplier and fallback dependencies exist?
Decision	Proceed to scoping, investigate dependencies first, or do not pursue? Under what conditions?

Individual assessment prompt

In no more than 500 words, define the ecosystem boundary for improving the timeliness of Kintaba's district crop-production estimates. Identify the critical actors, assets and flow; distinguish evidenced, reported and unknown claims; state the leading fitness-for-use problem; and recommend one next action. Your answer must explain why that action comes before or instead of an AI pilot.

Assessment rubric

Criterion	Points	Competent evidence
Boundary and public purpose	15	Domain, product, user decision, geography, period and exclusions are clear.
Actors roles and authority	15	Critical actors and distinct roles are correctly identified; authority is not assumed.
Assets and provenance	15	Multiple source types are inventoried with owners and material fitness issues.
Flow and dependencies	15	Transformations, handoffs, controls, responsibilities and failure points are traceable.
Evidence discipline	10	Material claims use E, R or U labels and references; unknowns remain visible.
Fitness for use	15	Quality requirements follow from the user decision and consequences.
AI judgement	10	Recommendation is bounded,

Criterion	Points	Competent evidence
		dependency-aware and does not bypass professional authority.
Communication	5	Map and conclusion are concise, internally consistent and defensible.

Decision rules

- Competent: 70 or more, at least half the available points in every criterion and no critical failure.
- Lead-level performance: 85 or more plus effective challenge of conflicting evidence and a defensible prioritization decision.
- Critical failures: inclusion of protected data without authorization; fabricated evidence; assigning release authority to an AI system; or recommending integration while concealing material incompatibility.
- Reassessment: correct the failed map elements and complete a new individual boundary-and-decision brief.

Workplace assignment

Within 30 days, map one approved statistical product or domain segment in the participant's institution. The assignment must remain manageable: normally five to fifteen actors, five to twenty assets and one critical flow.

Deliverable	Minimum
Scope and purpose	One page naming user decision, boundary, accountable sponsor and exclusions.
Actor register	Stable IDs, roles, authority reference, contact role and evidence status.
Asset register	Stable IDs, provenance, access, classifications, quality evidence and users.
Critical flow	Source-to-use handoffs, transformations, controls, delays, owner and fallback.
Need and fitness matrix	At least two user needs assessed as fit, conditionally fit or not fit.
Gap and action list	No more than five priority actions with owner, dependency and evidence need.
AI opportunity note	One bounded opportunity or a justified decision that AI is not presently appropriate.
Supervisor confirmation	Confirms safe scope, factual review and intended follow-up.

Follow-up questions

- What did the institutional chart fail to reveal?
- Which important claim remained unknown, and who could resolve it?
- Where did information lose meaning, quality, time or accountability?
- What improvement is possible without AI?
- What dependency must be solved before an AI use case can be screened?